

CONCLUSION

The **Nomad II MG** and the **Jukebox** rule the roost as of now. The Jukebox is ideal for the big boys to play with, while the Nomad II MG is the sleek and suave power accessory for those who are happier with small and feature-filled packages that suit their style. Both have great build quality, a nice interface, good audio transfer speeds, loads of features, support for the WMA format and come with a nice software bundle. Other features include quick firmware upgrades that enhance the functionality, such as support for larger memory cards in the Nomad II MG, to a more stable, reliable interface and the ability to use the Nomad Jukebox as a mobile hard drive. These may be the best performers available in the Indian market right now, but they don't come cheap. At around 1.5 to 1.8 times more than the price they sell for in the US, these devices are a bit too expensive for the average user.

At Rs 33,500, the Jukebox costs nothing less than a whole PC in India, while in the US it costs \$265, which is less than half the current Indian price. Import duties, taxes, and the vendors overpricing these products is killing a huge market share that these devices could gain.



Nomad II MG: A sleek and suave power accessory

The more practical alternatives to these two were the **D-Link DMP-100** and the **Philips eXpanium**, with the Rio PMP 300 right behind the D-Link in terms of the price to performance ratio. The D-Link comes at Rs 10,000 with 32 MB of memory that can be upgraded to 64 MB. It supports voice recording, has a nice interface, looks cool with its translucent iMac kind of looks and is very easy to use. Converse-



Nomad Jukebox: Big storage, easy-to-use interface

ly, even though the eXpanium doesn't excel in the features range, it's a very practical device when it comes to playing music on the move. Just pack in your CDs, a couple of AA battery packs and you're set for a long journey full of music. The Rio 300 is the cheapest of them all, and if you don't mind losing those extra features that the D-Link offers, is a fairly good player that can be upgraded to 64 MB. 

1/2 Page H AD